

KILLIFISH AND RELATIVES

Most members of the Cyprinodontiformes are small freshwater fish with a single dorsal fin and a large tail. Of the ten families, the guppies are perhaps the best known as they produce live young and are popular aquarium fish.



7 cm
2¾ in

tail important
in display

AMIET'S LYRETAIL
Fundulopanchax amieti
F: Nothobranchiidae

This small colourful fish lives in rainforest streams in Cameroon, Africa. There are many other similar species, known collectively as killifish.

FOUREYED FISH
Anableps anableps
F: Anablepidae

The bulging eyes of this S. American fish are divided so that it can see clearly both above and below water.



7.5 cm
3 in

BLACK PEARLFISH
Austrolebias nigripinnis
F: Rivulidae

Subtropical rivers in S. America are home to this species and all the other members of its colourful family.



5 cm
2 in

SAILFIN MOLLY
Poecilia latipinna
F: Poeciliidae

The large dorsal fin of this N. American fish is displayed in courtship. The female bears live young.



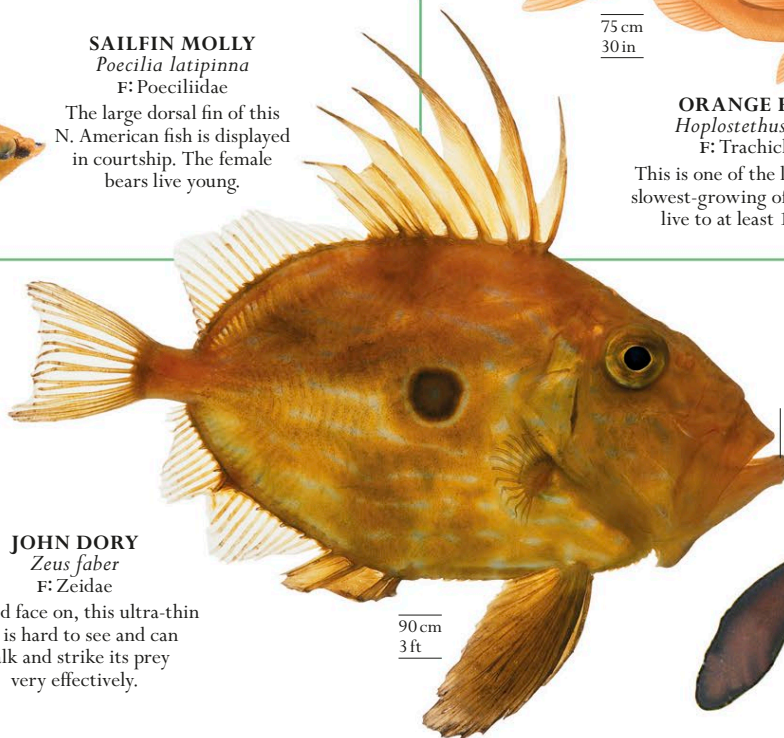
7 cm
2¾ in

DORIES AND RELATIVES

The 41 species belonging to the order Zeiformes are all marine, deep-bodied, but thin fish with long dorsal and anal fins. Dories have protrusible jaws – they can be shot out to capture prey. They feed on a wide range of small fish that they stalk head on.

JOHN DORY
Zeus faber
F: Zeidae

Viewed face on, this ultra-thin fish is hard to see and can stalk and strike its prey very effectively.



90 cm
3 ft

protrusible
jaw

SQUIRRELFISH AND ROUGHIES

These marine fish are deep-bodied with large scales, a forked tail, and sharp fin spines. Most of these fish (Beryciformes and Trachichthyiformes) are nocturnal and are often a red colour – a good disguise at night. Red light is absorbed first by water and red fish appear black below a certain depth.

CROWN SQUIRRELFISH
Sargocentron diadema
F: Holocentridae

This is a typical squirrelfish and one of many similar species found on tropical reefs. By day it hides in crevices.



17 cm
6½ in



22 cm
9 in

PINEAPPLEFISH
Cleidopus gloriamaris
F: Monocentridae

Few predators would attack this spiny fish, which has an armour of thick scales. Its colour warns that it is unpalatable.



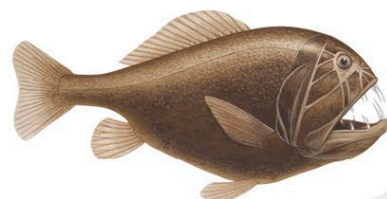
12 cm
4¾ in

EYELIGHT FISH
Photoblepharon palpebratum
F: Anomalopidae

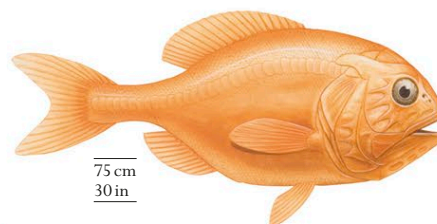
At night this fish signals to others using a light organ under each eye. It has a black membrane that it uses to cover the light, creating a flashing effect.

COMMON FANGTOOTH
Anoplogaster cornuta
F: Anoplogastridae

The huge fangs of this deep-ocean predator make escape impossible for its prey, which it swallows whole.



18 cm
7 in



75 cm
30 in

ORANGE ROUGHY
Hoplostethus atlanticus
F: Trachichthyidae

This is one of the longest-lived and slowest-growing of any fish and can live to at least 150 years old.

